

Cat Apartment Destruction Claw Caps — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

SIZE AND PREPARE CAPS CORRECTLY

- ☐ **Measure your cat's claw width to select the correct cap size, not based on cat size — if the cap covers more than two-thirds of the visible claw, go up a size immediately.:** Measure your cat's claw width to select the correct cap size, not based on cat size — if the cap covers more than two-thirds of the visible claw, go up a size immediately.
- ☐ **If caps fall off immediately or bunch at the tip, adjust the size accordingly — an improperly sized cap causes discomfort that makes your cat pull it off.:** If caps fall off immediately or bunch at the tip, adjust the size accordingly — an improperly sized cap causes discomfort that makes your cat pull it off.
- ☐ **Use only the adhesive that comes packaged with the caps — substitute glues do not bond properly and cause caps to fall off within days.:** Use only the adhesive that comes packaged with the caps — substitute glues do not bond properly and cause caps to fall off within days.
- ☐ **Clean each claw with a damp cotton ball before applying caps — the adhesive bonds to clean keratin, not to the oils and debris on unwashed claws.:** Clean each claw with a damp cotton ball before applying caps — the adhesive bonds to clean keratin, not to the oils and debris on unwashed claws.

APPLY CAPS USING PROPER TECHNIQUE

- ☐ **Gently press the paw pad to extend the claws fully before sliding each cap on — holding the cap in place for 5 full seconds ensures the adhesive cures properly.:** Gently press the paw pad to extend the claws fully before sliding each cap on — holding the cap in place for 5 full seconds ensures the adhesive cures properly.
 - ☐ **Start with the front paws only and limit sessions to two paws per day if your cat resists handling — forcing all four paws at once creates negative associations that make future applications impossible.:** Start with the front paws only and limit sessions to two paws per day if your cat resists handling — forcing all four paws at once creates negative associations that make future applications impossible.
-

- **Set a recurring 4-week calendar reminder to replace all caps — caps shed off naturally with the outer claw sheath, and one missed cycle means weeks of fully exposed claws.:** Set a recurring 4-week calendar reminder to replace all caps — caps shed off naturally with the outer claw sheath, and one missed cycle means weeks of fully exposed claws.
- **Size down immediately if your cat removes caps within days of application — the discomfort of a too-large cap is the primary reason most cats persistently pull them off.:** Size down immediately if your cat removes caps within days of application — the discomfort of a too-large cap is the primary reason most cats persistently pull them off.

MAINTAIN CAPS AND KNOW ALTERNATIVES

- **Switch to claw filing if caps consistently fail despite correct sizing and adhesive — use a human emery board or cat-specific nail file instead of clippers, which can split large claws.:** Switch to claw filing if caps consistently fail despite correct sizing and adhesive — use a human emery board or cat-specific nail file instead of clippers, which can split large claws.
- **File claws every 7 to 10 days, focusing on the front paws — rounding the sharp tip removes damage-causing edges without reshaping the claw structure.:** File claws every 7 to 10 days, focusing on the front paws — rounding the sharp tip removes damage-causing edges without reshaping the claw structure.
- **Round each claw tip until it no longer catches on drywall or fabric when tested — the goal is dulling the point, not changing the claw's natural shape.:** Round each claw tip until it no longer catches on drywall or fabric when tested — the goal is dulling the point, not changing the claw's natural shape.
- **Add enrichment activities if your cat pulls caps off as a stress response — address the anxiety driving displacement behavior rather than expecting caps alone to solve scratching issues.:** Add enrichment activities if your cat pulls caps off as a stress response — address the anxiety driving displacement behavior rather than expecting caps alone to solve scratching issues.